

itself which is fun, which we've mentioned quite a lot throughout this article so far. What the heck once more doesn't hurt and we'll probably mention it again. But nevertheless, we asked the cosplayers what they found was the most fun aspect of cosplaying. The majority said that it was simply the fact that they could be a completely different person, take on the traits of their favorite characters, and transform themselves. The feeling of satisfaction they got from creating their costumes and having it turn out the way they envisioned it was the most fun aspect for the guys from Scythes SkunkWorks. Pracheta got her fun from having people guess the character she was cosplaying as.

Now when one thinks cosplay, our minds immediately shift to all things geek. So naturally we had to ask the cosplayers whether they would still cosplay if they weren't associated with any geekdoms. Aorin says that she's not too sure about that. Her main reason for cosplaying is because she loves the characters, the games, the anime, and the comic books. Similarly even Rhea cannot imagine not being an anime fan or comic book lover. Syrinx says that she probably wouldn't even have been introduced to cosplay if she weren't part of the geek world. However there are some exceptions. Some are simply in awe of the process itself and just enjoy the many aspects of it, such as the photo shoots and the work that goes into costumes, so you don't necessarily need to be familiar with the character to dress up as them. And for others it's simply a hobby to escape from their boring daily schedules.

We asked the cosplayers what kind or type of cosplay they most did. We found that most didn't limit themselves to any particular geekdom. We found a majority cosplayed characters from anime and video games, closely followed by comic book characters. SkunkWorks have a variety of cosplay genre's under their belt, with characters from games, to movies and even cartoons and web series. Cosplay allows you to interpret your favorite character in a way you like best. It allows you to



On the top we have Syrinx and Vijay Singh and below we have the guys from Scythes SkunkWorks strutting their stuff.

add a personal touch to the character. Rhea for example, usually cosplays characters she can connect with. All she needs is to see a very small part of that character in herself to get going.

THE WORKS

In order to cosplay you're going to need an outfit. And an integral part of the cosplaying process is making or preparing your costume. And this is something that all cosplayers agreed upon. Making a costume can be extremely time consuming. Some character designs are, to be frank, downright absurd and it takes a whole lot of props to pull them off. And props are an integral part of most costumes. The time that goes into creating costumes can be anywhere from less than 20 minutes to over a hundred hours. Yes, a hundred. Wow! Just goes

to show you the dedication these guys put into the details for their costumes.

A lot of research goes into building props, the original character, other's interpretation of the character and so on. A lot of time goes into the detailing and accuracy of props, even acquiring the tools needed for the job is an important aspect of the whole process. And of course speaking with your fellow cosplayers also helps, as they're more than willing to share their techniques!

Budget is also an important factor, along with the availability of materials. The amount that is spent on costumes can vary as much as the time taken does. In some cases it could be as little as ₹250 and in other cases it could be well over ₹15k. It depends on the complexity of the character you intend to cosplay. You can be smart about it and save up on a lot of money. Additionally, the photo shoots, or hiring a photographer can also be expensive. What you can decipher from this is that cosplaying is not a cheap hobby to have and can take quite a toll on your wallets.

So if you've got the budget, desire, and the determination, naturally the next step is to find a place where you can showcase your cosplay. And there's no shortage of events in the country where you can cosplay to your hearts content. Some of the events held around our country such as the World Cosplay Summit, the MFCC, the Cool Japan Festival, and IGX are great places for you to meet with fellow geeks and literally spread your prop wings.

Famous international cosplayers: Lucia Cosplay, Mon and LALAax, Kamui (Svetlana Quindt), Sosenka, Enji Night, April Gloria, Yüegene Fay, Reika, Eve Beauregard, Leon Chiro, Elffi, Konomi Akira, Miss Hatred, Dustbunny and Alodia.

THE SCENE (IN INDIA)

Cosplaying seems like a fun thing, so we wondered why there wasn't more of it happening around here. We got a mixed response of sorts. Like gaming, cosplay is a growing culture. There's still some taboo in our country over anything geek/nerd related. However, it seems that this hasn't deterred anyone at all. According